

## "HE IS TOO NAÏVE" |||

Dutt's US-based daughter Trishala, 19, spoke to our sister television channel Aaj Tak just before the judgement. Excerpts:

"I'm not thinking about it. I could not sleep the whole night. I felt very bad that I could not be with him at that time. I prayed to God that my father would come out free and that he would be brave. I cried."

"I told him to keep his chin high up because everything is going to be fine. I go to the temple and pray. It has been stressful for the whole family."

"He always tells me that I should get a good education and be a good person. He tells me to be humble in my life. I feel that a lot of people use my father in different ways. They manipulate him. He can't see it, but I can. He is emotional and naïve."

"My father means a lot to me. I won't accept any woman in his life. And he has said that he would never marry again. It is not true that he has plans to marry."

"Right now I'm pursuing my education. I'm doing my degree in law. About three-and-a-half years later, I might come back to India and try my luck in acting."



**FATHER'S DAY:** Trishala Dutt with her dad Sanjay during the trial

battery of lawyers began working on the appeal they intend to file with the Supreme Court, as any TADA court judgement can only be taken up for appeal with the apex court. While Maneshinde refuses to divulge the details of the appeal, he says, "We already have the operative part of the judgement, but we will file an appeal only after we have decided our strategy. Our plea will be to set aside the sentence."

Noted criminal lawyer Mahesh Jethmalani claims Dutt never had any option but to appeal to the Supreme Court. "The whole proceeding of applying under the Probation of Offenders Act was legally misconceived. It didn't apply to him—he was a 34-year-old man at the time of the act. The judge had no choice but to sentence him to a minimum of five years."

Most in the legal fraternity, too, believed that Dutt, because of his celebrity status and larger-than-life image, would have it easy, but as criminal lawyer Majeed Memon says: "This did not happen, and it appears that the judge stood above all extra-legal pressures. However, this doesn't mean that the findings recorded by the trial judge are final and correct. Dutt has a right to appeal and the Supreme Court will examine the correctness of the find-



**JUDGEMENT DAY:** Sanjay's sisters and their husbands outside the court on the day of the sentence